

The illustration depicts a blue ocean with green waves. In the upper left, a cluster of colorful plastic waste floats on the surface, including a blue water bottle, a yellow cup, and various pieces of debris. Several blue sea skaters with long legs are shown on the water's surface. One sea skater is on a piece of white plastic. In the center, a magnified view of plankton is shown. In the lower left, a sea skater is on a piece of white plastic, with orange eggs nearby. In the lower right, a sea skater is on a green wave. The background shows a blue sky with a white sun.

Sea skaters have been found living on
The Great Pacific Garbage Patch—an
enormous area of waste floating in
the middle of the ocean.

Future danger

Too many sea skaters upsets
the balance of the ocean's
ecosystem. They eat the
plankton that other creatures,
such as whales, depend
on for survival.

Magnified
plankton

Before the arrival of
plastic, sea skaters laid
their eggs on feathers
and shells.

Sea skaters stay afloat
using tiny bubbles that stick
to the hairs on their six legs.

Eggs